

Derrick Auyoung

Engineering Manager

+1-951-326-6847 | derrick.auyoung@gmail.com | Temecula, CA, U.S.A.

Portfolio: <https://derrickauyoung.github.io/aboutderrick/>

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/derrick-auyoung-0956162/>

IMDB: <https://www.imdb.com/name/nm1652099>

SKILLS

- Leadership of Cross-Disciplinary Teams
- Strategic Technology Planning
- Stakeholder Engagement
- Workflow Optimization

EXPERIENCE

Weta Digital/Unity, Wellington, NZ - Head of Motion R&D

MAY 2016 - OCT 2024

- Shaped the strategy for motion and animation tooling by identifying trends and driving adoption of next-gen solutions.
- Collaborated with leadership to align tool improvements with user workflows and company objectives.
- Owned animation technology roadmaps, prioritizing features based on user feedback, time criticality, feasibility, and strategic impact.
- Leveraged adoption metrics and performance data to inform iterative improvements and long-term growth.
- Led a team of 15 engineers and two team leads to deliver tools for blockbuster franchises like *Avatar*, *Planet of the Apes*, *The Hobbit*, and *Avengers*.
- Led engineers to port VFX Animation pipeline data to Unreal Engine for the *Meerkat* experience, *The Matrix Awakens*, *Fortnite* and *Overwatch* shorts.
- Communicated complex workflows as actionable insights for executives and stakeholders, securing alignment and buy-in.

Wētā FX, Wellington, NZ - Domain Technology Engagement Supervisor

OCT 2024 - MAY 2025

- Aligned technology and production teams to bridge creative needs with technical solutions, optimizing workflows.

- Translated complex requirements into actionable strategies, fostering cross-discipline collaboration.
- Applied root-cause analysis and lean methods to eliminate inefficiencies and increase tool stability, boosting user satisfaction by 20%.

Wētā FX, Remote - Domain Technology Staff Software Engineer

MAY 2025 - Present

- Python & C++ Development for Tools and Pipeline for Animation and Adjacent Departments

Weta Digital, Wellington, NZ - Lead Animation TD, Animator

NOV 2006 - MAY 2016

- Developed and maintained animation tools for Maya and publishing workflows, streamlining scene setup and enhancing productivity.
- Conducted user testing with animators to refine tools, addressing usability challenges and evolving production needs.
- Led the creation of next-gen motion pipeline tooling, Chronos, integrating new scene description and fostering cross-team alignment.
- Contributed as a character animator on *Rise of the Planet of the Apes*.

Rhythm & Hues, Los Angeles, CA - Lead Animation Layout TD, Animator, Pipeline TD

JUN 2003 - NOV 2006

- Developed tools and systems that streamlined production and scene assembly workflows, increasing productivity for layout artists and animators on films: *The Chronicles of Narnia* and *The Ring 2*.
- Contributed as an animator for *Night at the Museum*.

CERTIFICATION

- Certificate of Professional Scrum Product Owner, August 2021
- Certified Unity Hiring Manager at Social Talent, April 2023

EDUCATION

UCLA, Los Angeles, CA - B.S., Computer Science

SEP 1999 - JUN 2003

- Major in Computer Science with a Minor in Design | Media Arts and concentration in Film and Computer Animation